

NOISE AND HEARING CONSERVATION

Measure and reduce noise at source where feasible, preventing hearing loss through engineering controls, exposure-time management and correct hearing protection.

PURPOSE AND SCOPE

Measure and reduce noise at source where feasible, preventing hearing loss through engineering controls, exposure-time management and correct hearing protection.

KEY HAZARDS

 HIGH NOISE	 IMPACT NOISE	 LONG EXPOSURE	 POOR PLUG FIT
 LOST COMMUNICATION	 MISSED ALARM	 DAMAGED PROTECTOR	 HEARING LOSS

CRITICAL VALUES TO VERIFY IN THE FIELD

85 dBA 8-hour TWA hearing-conservation action level	90 dBA 8-hour TWA permissible exposure	Annual Audiogram for covered employees
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REMEMBER - SERNEM

S

Stop and think

E

Evaluate the risk

R

Remove or reduce

N

Never assume

E

Ensure protection

M

Monitor and communicate

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STANDARDS AND FIELD REQUIREMENTS

OSHA 1910.95 addresses monitoring, engineering/administrative controls, hearing conservation, audiometry, protector selection and training.

OSHA 1910.95(b) EXPOSURE CONTROL

Use feasible engineering or administrative controls above permissible exposure levels.

OSHA 1910.95(d) MONITORING

Conduct representative personal or area monitoring where 85 dBA 8-hour TWA may be reached, and repeat after change.

OSHA 1910.95(g) AUDIOMETRY

Provide baseline and annual audiograms to covered employees and evaluate significant shifts.

OSHA 1910.95(i) HEARING PROTECTORS

Offer suitable choices, train correct fitting and verify effective field attenuation.

MINIMUM EVIDENCE BEFORE START

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Noise-survey map | ☐ Personal dosimetry record |
| ☐ Engineering-control plan | ☐ Protector selection / attenuation calculation |
| ☐ Audiometry program | ☐ Training record |

SUPERVISOR DISCUSSION POINTS

- What is today's measured level?
- How can we reduce the source?
- How is the protector fitted correctly?

NOISE MONITORING AND CORRECT PROTECTOR FIT



Monitoring - Source control - Zone - Correct fit - Audiometry



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Measure and reduce noise at source where feasible, preventing hearing loss through engineering controls, exposure-time management, and PPE.

CRITICAL CONTROL MEASURES (HIERARCHY OF CONTROLS)

1. ELIMINATE NOISY WORK

Select quieter equipment and methods; consider noise data during procurement.

2. ISOLATE THE SOURCE

Use silencers, enclosures, barriers, maintenance and vibration isolation.

3. CONTROL TIME AND AREA

Reduce exposure time, control the zone and preserve alarms and communication.

4. FIT CORRECT PROTECTION

Fit plugs or muffs correctly; use dual protection and fit verification where required.

CRITICAL WARNING



Ringling ears or temporary post-shift hearing reduction is an early warning. Report exposure; do not rely on PPE alone.

SITE CHECKLIST (BEFORE STARTING WORK)

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Noise survey current | ☐ Source controls working |
| ☐ Zone controlled | ☐ Exposure time planned |
| ☐ Protector correctly selected | ☐ Earplug correctly fitted |
| ☐ Earmuffs intact | ☐ Alarm remains audible |
| ☐ Team briefed | |



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Measure and reduce noise at source where feasible, preventing hearing loss through engineering controls, exposure-time management

ATTENDANCE AND APPROVAL

Project / Site: _____ Date: _____

Presented by: _____ Work area: _____

No	Full Name	Company / Role	Signature
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			
9			
10			
11			
12			